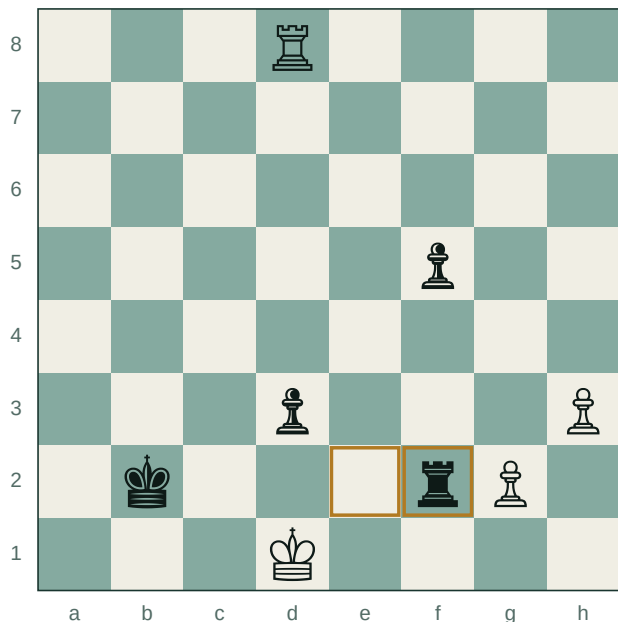


Rook-ending tactics: White, move 49

Rook-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 48...Rxf2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

49. Rxd3 Rxd2 50. Rd2+ Rxd2+ 51. Kxd2

49.Rxd3 The rook captures the pawn on d3. Recorded reply: **49...Rxd2**.

50.Rd2+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From d2 it attacks king on b2 and rook on g2. Recorded reply: **50...Rxd2+**.

51.Kxd2 The king captures the rook on d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 1 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on b2. Geometrically undefended: rook on f2. Check for tactical protection.